

Series Title: Lighting Candles

Dates: Nov 30 - Dec 21

Vision For The Event

The Advent season is a time of anticipation and preparation, and Lighting Candles centers on the four themes represented by the Advent candles: Hope, Peace, Joy, and Love. Each week, the congregation will explore one theme through Scripture, reflection, and accompanying videos from The Bible Project Advent Series. This series invites the congregation to prepare their hearts for the arrival of Christ, discovering how these themes illuminate God’s plan for salvation and their place within it.

By integrating Scripture with engaging visual storytelling, the series aims to deepen understanding, spark reflection, and inspire action, culminating in the celebration of Christ's birth.

The Goals of the Series

- Cultivate a sense of anticipation and spiritual preparation for Christmas.
- Explore how the themes of Hope, Peace, Joy, and Love are fulfilled in Christ.
- Encourage practical applications of each theme in daily life, helping the congregation live as Christ’s disciples during Advent and beyond.

Sermon Schedule

Sunday	Sermon Title	Scripture
11/30/25	Hope	Matthew 24:36-44
12/7/25	Peace	Isaiah 11:1-10
12/14/25	Joy	Luke 1:46b-55
12/21/25	Love	John 3:16-21

Synopses

These synopses were created as sermon summaries by Chat GPT.

Week 1 | Hope | Matthew 24:36-44

The first candle of Advent represents hope, reminding us to look forward with anticipation to Christ's return. This sermon unpacks Jesus' teaching on being watchful and prepared, urging the congregation to embrace hope as a posture of trust and expectation. The accompanying *Bible Project* video introduces the biblical meaning of hope, showing how it is grounded in God's faithfulness rather than fleeting optimism.

Week 2 | Peace | Isaiah 11:1-10

The second candle represents peace, echoing the vision of Isaiah's prophecy where harmony is restored to creation through the reign of the Messiah. This sermon explores the nature of true peace, emphasizing that it is not merely the absence of conflict but the presence of justice and wholeness. The Bible Project video on peace highlights how Jesus fulfills this promise, inviting the congregation to become peacemakers in their own lives.

Week 3 | Joy | Luke 1:46b-55

The third candle of Advent signifies joy, reflected in Mary's song of praise. This sermon delves into the overflowing joy of the Magnificat, celebrating how God's work in Mary is a sign of His ongoing work in the world. The *Bible Project* video on joy illuminates the deep, abiding joy that comes from trusting in God's promises, even amid uncertainty and waiting.

Week 4 | Love | John 3:16-21

The final candle of Advent symbolizes love, the heart of the Christmas message. This sermon focuses on God's immense love for the world, expressed through the gift of His Son. The *Bible Project* video on love emphasizes how this divine love calls us to love others selflessly. The congregation is invited to reflect on how they can embody this love in their relationships and communities.